

Release & Implementation Plan

1. Purpose

This document defines the high-level release and implementation approach for the improved SAP-supported Customer Service process.

The objective is to ensure that approved process and application changes are validated, communicated, deployed and monitored in a controlled manner.

2. Release Scope

The release includes the approved customer-service process improvements represented in this case study:

- Mandatory service-request information
- Standardized case categorization and prioritization
- Defined case-routing rules
- Remote versus Field Service decision criteria
- Standardized Field Service handover
- Field Service readiness validation
- Field Service status and result visibility
- Standardized case-resolution and closure criteria

The target landscape includes SAP Service Cloud, relevant SAP S/4HANA integration and Field Service capabilities where on-site service is required.

3. Pre-Release Activities

Before production deployment:

1. Confirm approved business and functional requirements.
 2. Confirm Jira change items are in the appropriate implementation status.
 3. Complete functional/system testing.
 4. Complete integration testing where applicable.
 5. Complete UAT with business key users.
 6. Resolve or formally accept relevant defects.
 7. Obtain business/UAT approval.
 8. Confirm release scope.
 9. Prepare user/process documentation.
 10. Communicate planned changes to affected stakeholders.
 11. Confirm deployment and support responsibilities.
 12. Confirm rollback/contingency approach with the responsible technical teams.
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4. Implementation Approach

The release follows a controlled implementation lifecycle:

Approved Requirements → Configuration/Development → Technical & Integration Testing → UAT → Business Approval → Production Deployment → Validation → Hypercare → Normal Operations

The responsible SAP technical and functional teams execute the required technical deployment activities according to the organization's release-management procedures.

The Application Process Manager coordinates the business/process perspective and ensures that the implemented change remains aligned with the approved requirements.

5. Go-Live Readiness

Before go-live, the following should be confirmed:

Readiness Area	Expected Status
Requirements approved	Complete
Functional changes validated	Complete
Integration testing	Complete
UAT	Passed
Critical defects	Resolved
Business approval	Received
User/process documentation	Available
Key-user communication	Completed
Deployment plan	Confirmed
Support responsibilities	Confirmed
Rollback/contingency approach	Confirmed

6. Communication & Change Management

Affected stakeholders should be informed about:

- What is changing
- Why the process is changing
- When the change becomes effective
- New or changed user activities
- Updated case information requirements
- Routing/process changes
- Field Service handover requirements
- Where updated documentation is located
- Where users should report issues after go-live

Key users should receive sufficient information or training before production use.

7. Go-Live

During deployment:

- Technical teams execute the approved deployment activities.
 - Relevant integrations and application availability are verified.
 - Critical business scenarios are checked after deployment.
 - Key stakeholders are informed of deployment status.
 - Any critical issue is escalated according to the agreed support process.
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8. Hypercare / Post-Go-Live Support

A short hypercare period should follow go-live.

During this period:

- User issues are monitored.
 - Incorrect case routing is monitored.
 - Integration issues are monitored.
 - Field Service handover problems are reviewed.
 - Critical incidents are prioritized.
 - User feedback is collected.
 - Required corrections are tracked through the agreed change-management process.
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9. Post-Go-Live KPIs

The following KPIs can be monitored:

- Case volume
- First response time
- Resolution time
- Case reassignment rate
- Field Service handover rework
- SLA compliance
- Percentage of remotely resolved cases
- Field Service escalation rate
- Case closure quality
- Relevant user/customer feedback indicators

The KPI results can support continuous process improvement.

10. Roles and Responsibilities

Application Process Manager

- Coordinates business requirements and process changes.
- Maintains alignment between process, business and application teams.
- Supports requirement clarification.
- Coordinates business validation and UAT.
- Supports release-readiness assessment.
- Coordinates stakeholder communication.
- Supports post-go-live issue analysis and continuous improvement.

Business / Key Users

- Validate business requirements.
- Participate in UAT.
- Confirm that the solution supports operational needs.
- Provide business feedback after go-live.

SAP Functional / Technical Teams

- Design/configure/implement the approved solution.
- Perform technical and functional validation.
- Support defect resolution.
- Execute or support deployment according to release procedures.

Integration Team

- Implement and validate relevant system integrations.
- Investigate integration-related defects.

Release / Change Management

- Coordinates the formal deployment process.
- Ensures organizational release procedures are followed.
- Coordinates release scheduling and approvals.

11. Case Study Assumption

This release and implementation plan represents a simulated portfolio scenario.

No productive SAP system was deployed as part of this case study. The document demonstrates the process-management, requirements, testing, release-coordination and stakeholder-management activities expected in a realistic application/process change lifecycle.